

Whtr.in

This is a newly launched site that uses geo-location information to tell you what the weather's going to be like

**HTC Desire HD for ₹27,499**

HTC Desire HD started pre-orders on Indian web sites at ₹27,499, and will start selling by January 2011

Google Chrome Web Store now open for business

Not in India of course. The Google Chrome Web Store, the suspiciously "open" web store that will only work on Google's Chrome browser is now open for business.

To make it easier to discover applications and pay for them and authenticate to them, Google had announced during Google I/O 2010 that they would be launching a store of sorts for web applications, where people could browse, discover and purchase web applications just as they could normal desktop applications.

Soon after Google had opened up the Web Store for developers to post their applications. Developing applications for the Chrome Web Store could be as simple as pointing it to your current web site or service, to enabling specific desktop integration features such as offline storage, Geolocation, notifications etc.

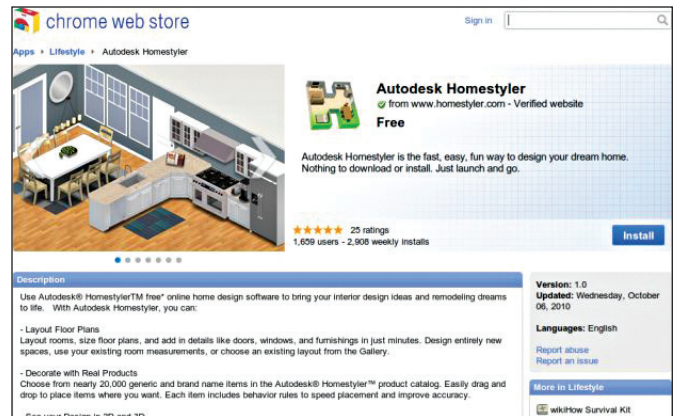
The mechanism for working with Google Chrome Web Apps is quite similar to working with Google Chrome extensions. You simply browse the Google Chrome Web Store, find an application you like and click on "Install". If the application is a paid product, then there is an intermediary step in which you pay for the app/service. Applications installed onto Chrome will appear on your new tab page, from where you can set an application's options and you can set how to launch the application. You can set applications to launch as normal tabs, pinned tabs or in fullscreen.

Since Google Chrome has supported syncing applications and extensions to your Google

Chrome profile for a while now, it is possible for you to enable the same, and get the same consistent list of applications installed on all your Google Chrome instances and devices.

The Google Chrome Web Store is meant to compliment the Google Chrome OS-based netbooks that Google has just begun sending to testers. With a netbook that runs only a browser, and where all applications are run in the browser, the feasibility of web applications as replacements for desktops will be put to a serious test.

Meanwhile Mozilla has its own plans for a completely open web store ecosystem that unlike Google's Chrome Web Store is not tied to any browser. Mozilla's concept goes beyond any single store or single provider, but aims instead to be like the internet decentralized. Mozilla continues to refine its plans even as Google's store goes online.



Experience apps at Chrome's web store

With browsers and internet speeds getting increasingly faster, even complicated web applications such as image editors, video editors and even 3D applications are becoming feasible and available. Google Chrome itself is seeing an increasing share in usage, and the Web store will only help in that. With paid applications tied to a particular browser though, users will quickly become lim-

ited to Google Chrome after they have made a few purchases, and will not be able to take advantage of latest developments in other browsers.

While the Google Chrome Web Store is an interesting concept that takes the concept of web applications forward, it does seem to take a step back as well. We look forward to further developments in Mozilla's Open Web Store concept. **[d]**

Google Wave to live on as Apache Wave

Google Wave was an incredibly optimistic Google project aimed at the future of communication, but ended up in the scrap pile. We believe that Google's decision to abandon the project was a little too early, but that's all in the past. Google Wave will now live on as Apache Wave.

While Wave's protocol was released as an open specification, and other companies have made products based on the technology, there wasn't a complete Google Wave server available that was as complete as Google's

own implementation. Google intended to rectify that, and allow people to export all their Google Wave data before shutting down Google Wave for good at the end of this year. Google was to release what it called "Wave in the Box" a complete implementation of Wave that anyone could host on their own server. Since no solution is currently available to replace Google Wave, the service will continue to operate until there is a way for everyone to export their waves from Google Wave and host them on their own server.

As an open source product that intends to go beyond a single vendor, and become a part of the future of the internet itself, Apache is possibly the best home for Google Wave. Apache is known for the Apache HTTP server that is the most popular open source server in existence. It is one of the most successful open source projects of all time, and is often bundled even with proprietary applications.

Now part of Apache's incubator program, Wave should grow since Google believes there exists "a healthy community of startups, independent developers, and industry partners enthusiastic to continue development of the Wave Federation protocols and Wave in a Box product". **[d]**